



IIT ROORKEE



NPTEL ONLINE
CERTIFICATION COURSE

Public Speaking

Lecture 21- Classroom Lectures

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DEPARTMENT OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES



Classroom Lectures

The fundamental characteristics of effective lecturing in the classroom comprise:

- Expressiveness
- Clarity
- Interaction
- Inclusiveness
- Empathy



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Prior Visit
to
Classroom
& Practice

Having a
backup
plan

Planning
visual aids
beforehand

Preparing in Advance

Speaking
notes

Including
delivery
reminders

Time
Management

- **A Prior Visit to Classroom**

The layout of the desks and sitting arrangement are required to get acquainted with because it determines the movement while delivering the lecture. The availability of equipment is also needed to be taken into account.

- **Having a Backup Plan**

The backup plan should always be there to avoid any technical glitch as they affect the credibility of the lecturer even when it is not their fault.

Planning Visual Aids Beforehand

Chalking out the introduction, explanation, and summarization of the main ideas and their interconnectedness- and all of it should be done keeping students' attention intact.

Speaking Notes

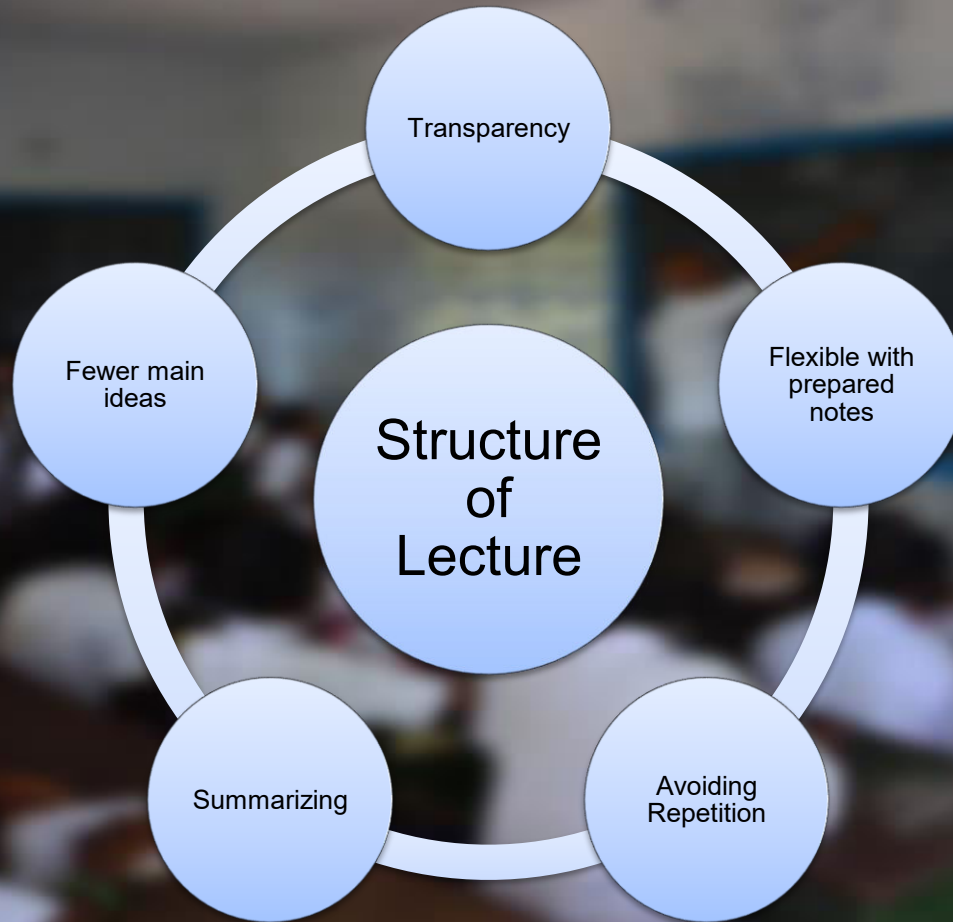
An outline of the entire course of the lecture is required: right from the introduction to necessary pauses and digressions to the concluding remarks while preparing notes. However, the entire lecture should not be read from sheets of paper or PowerPoint presentations. The lectures should be engaging.

Including Delivery Reminders

While preparing the notes, one should also keep reminding oneself to smile, make the lecture inclusive, and make room for pauses and breaths.

Prior Practice of Lecture

Planning a lecture theoretically and executing the plan has a gap that can only be bridged if it is practiced beforehand. One may not be able to estimate how much can really be delivered in the given time span. One should also take into account that students' questions take time as well.



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Transparency

Communication with students should not be presumptuous. A connection with the previous lecture must be established which can be done by mentioning the key points of the previous lecture and the end should encompass the briefing for the next lecture along with reminders about reading and assignments if any.

Fewer Main Ideas

Any lecture should not be flooded with several main ideas. The key points should be selected beforehand and the lecture should revolve around those few main ideas. Coherence is an essential component of any good lecture.

Flexible with Prepared Notes

Teaching is a dynamic job based on interactions. Participation of students is an important factor so the lecture should adapt to those circumstances. The notes are secondary to the impromptu circumstances or discussions that arise in the assigned time span.

Avoid Repetition

One thing that every teacher should keep in mind is that the lectures should be catchy and not repetitive. Time and again, one should keep brushing up on the materials being used for lectures and new examples should be stated in order to anchor the interests of the students.

Summarizing

As mentioned earlier, connecting ideas in a series of lectures is very important. While transitioning from one topic to the other, one should be explicit and make use of brief summaries in order to revisit all the important points of the lecture. This helps the student to revise the main points of the lecture in an organized nutshell.

Means for Engaging Class

Ask, then tell

Shifting engagement levels

Questioning to intrigue

Short Breaks

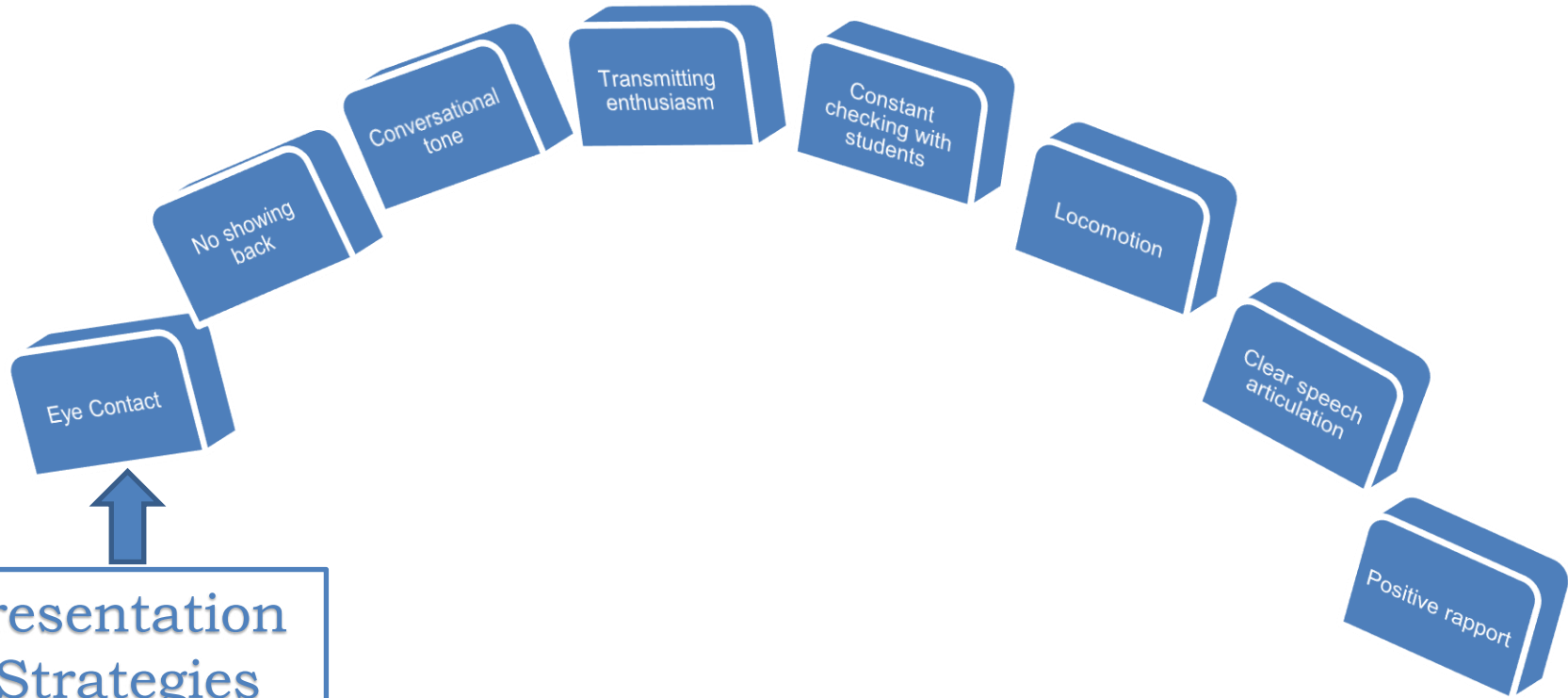
Inviting Questions

Practice inclusivity

Encouraging note-taking

Feedback

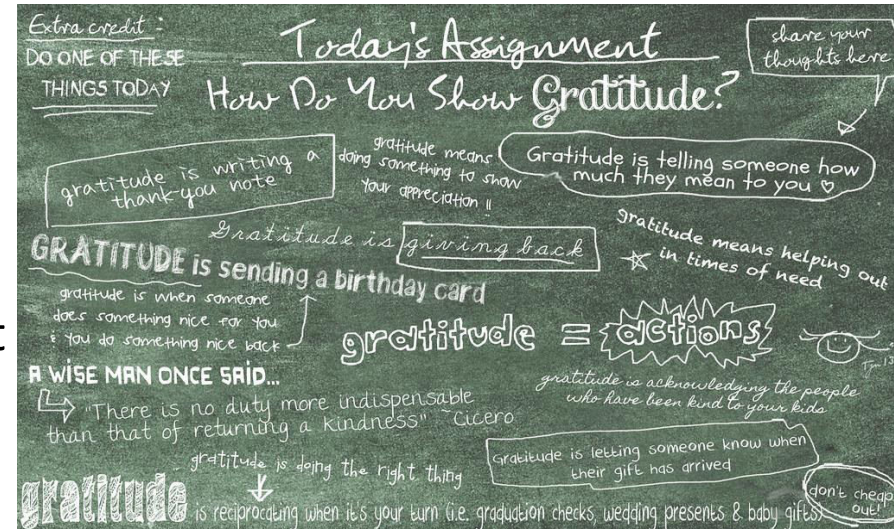
Presentation Strategies



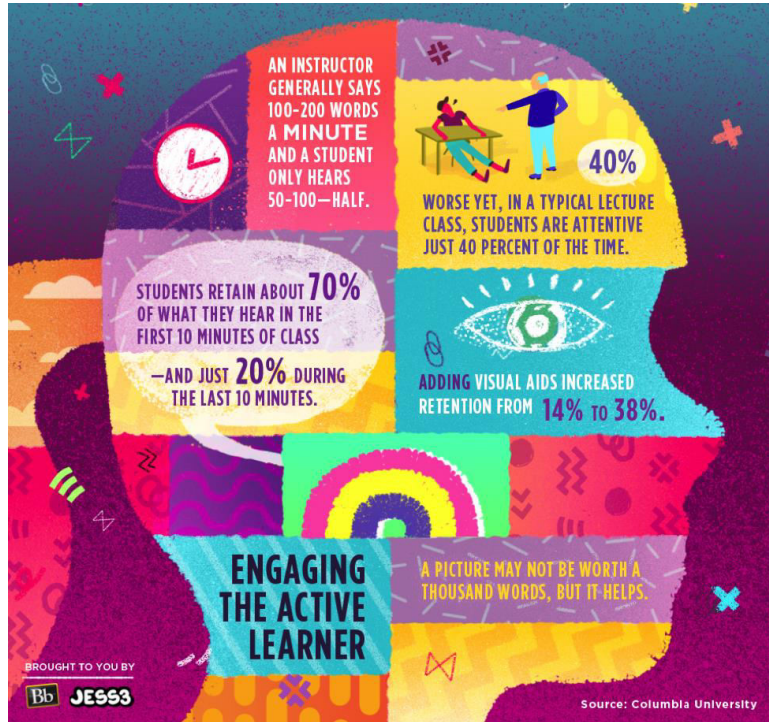
Instructional Media and Technology

Chalkboard

It is mostly taken for granted but it is an extremely effective tool in classrooms. It can be used for outlining the lecture's topic with its main points. It is handy while summarizing ideas that surfaced during class discussions. Any new word can be communicated with ease. It is commonly available and accessible.



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Visual Aids

- ☐ The use of multimedia aids helps to maintain students' attention. One should take care of the fact that it should only be used as a support and not the focus of the lecture.
- ☐ Not everything that is to be said should be there on the slides.
- ☐ There should be a gradual revelation of visual information.

Role of Feedback

- Feedback makes any learning an active process.
- It allows both teachers and students to contemplate and direct their individual learning.
- Feedback should always be given without delay. Only then it would be of any use.



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Some Tips

- ❖ Be confident of your content
- ❖ Make your lecture sequential
(Topical, Casual, Sequential, Graphic, Structural, Problem Solution)
- ❖ Avoid speaking throughout
- ❖ Keep track of time
- ❖ Vary the type of lectures
- ❖ Avoid lecturing verbatim

Prepare for the ear and
not for the eye

“The philosophy of the schoolroom in one generation
will be the philosophy of government in the next”

-Abraham Lincoln

Thank You

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Public Speaking

Lecture 22: Kinesics

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DEPARTMENT OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES





“Man is a multi-sensorial being. Occasionally he verbalizes...and we must seriously examine the implications of the fact that man does not communicate by word alone”

- Ray Birdwhistell

Communicating without Words

- ❖ Non-verbal communication is unstructured.
- ❖ It compensates for the deficiency of verbal communication.
- ❖ It also supplements our verbal communication.
- ❖ Non verbal signals involve three
- ❖ Categories of language: sign language, action language and object language.

“He who has eyes to see and ears to hear can convince that no mortal can keep a secret. If his lips are silent, he chatters with his finger tips, betrayal oozes out of him at every pore.”

-Sigmund Freud



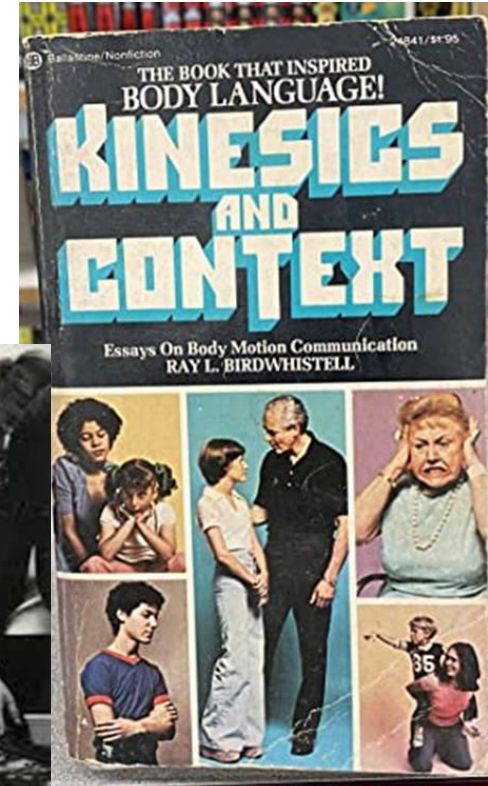
What is Kinesics?

It is a term introduced in the year 1952 by Ray Birdwhistell.

Kinesics aims to study the non-verbal mode of human communication.

Non-verbal communication includes interpretation of body movements such as:

- Facial expressions.
- Gestures
- Postures
- Gait
- Visible arm movements
- Body movements



Parts of Kinesics



Facial
expressions



Gestures



Posture



Gait



Arm
movements



Body
movements

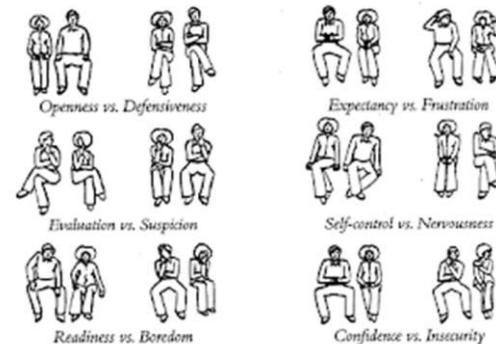
Body Movements

1. It is the largest physical gesture that a speaker can demonstrate on the stage.
2. The larger the gesture; the larger the impact.

Standing:

- Move between transitioning from one point to another.
- Act out examples or stories. Make it engaging.
- Record yourself while preparing time and augment coordination between words and body.

Sitting: It is possible to non-verbally communicate and send signals to the person at the other end of the table. During an interview-like situation, one shall follow the positive types as given in the image below.



Engaging Approachable Body Language

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Facial Expressions

- Studies suggest that with 43 muscles under our facial skin, we are capable of producing thousands of different expressions.
- Each expression carries its own meaning and impact.
- Better equipment of facial expression shows quality of higher emotional intelligence.
- In Indian aesthetics and traditional dance forms, like Bharatanatyam, *rasas* (tastes) are expressed primarily through facial expression.



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Posed and Emotional Facial Expressions

Posed Facial Expressions	Emotional Facial Expressions
Tailored	Spontaneous
The speaker delivers an intended facial expression in order to communicate.	Mostly unintended. it is emotional, raw and spontaneous.
Several factors like thought, language, culture determines the style of expressions.	Reflection of one's internal emotion through facial gestures.
External situations (audience, situation etc.) project a significant control on one's facial expression too.	Glossophobia might evoke emotive facial expressions than posed.

Rasa Theory

- ❖ *Rasas* are considered to be physical manifestations of one's emotions, that is, *gunas*.
- ❖ Traditional dance artists mostly try to express the nine *rasas* basically through means of kinesics.
- ❖ Such a capability of posing intense emotions through facial expression requires high emotional intelligence and artistic talent.
- ❖ Orators too are like artists who can gain inspiration by projecting different *rasas*, as required, while public speaking.



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Navararasas/Nine Rasas



Shringara
(Love)



Adhbuta
(Wonder)



Hasya
(Laughter)



Karuna
(Sorrow)



Bhayanaka
(Terror)



Bibhatsa
(Disgust)



Raudra
(Anger)



Veera
(Courage)



Shantha
(Peace)



Evocation of *Rasas* in Public Speaking

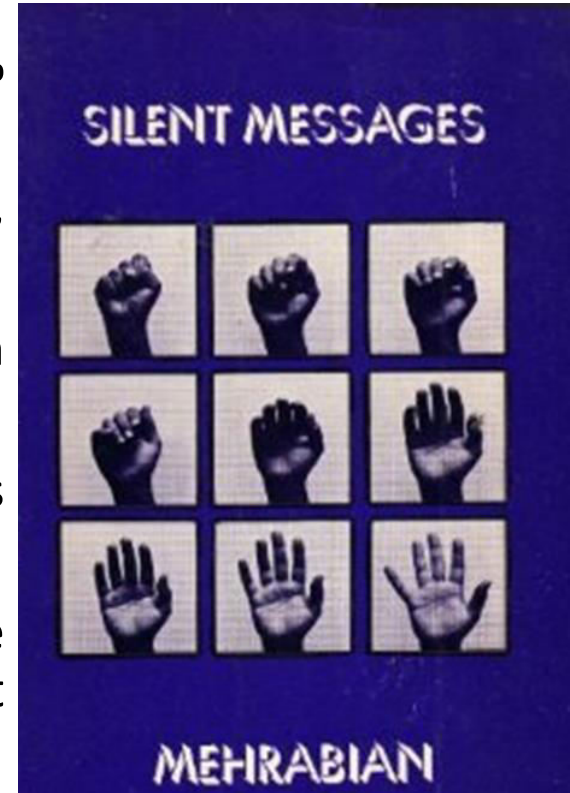
Although entertainment is just a partial reason behind the evocation of *rasas*, the main **purpose** lies in the **transference of values and emotions to the spectators**.



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Gestures

- ❑ Studies suggest that “communication is only 7% verbal and 93% non-verbal.” (Mehrabian 44)
- ❑ Gestures are reflected through movement of hands, arms, shoulders and torso.
- ❑ Rather than sitting and talking passively, one can make use of gestures to bring attention closer.
- ❑ Parallel communication through gestures doubles the effect intended on the audience.
- ❑ However, the public speaker must be aware of the cultural significance of specific gestures with respect to the audience, place and situation.



Types of Gesture and their Meaning

Enumerative
Descriptive
Locative
Symbolic
Emphatic

Number or distance
Size of the object
Location of an object
Subtle suggestion
Emphasis

Hand movements are symbolical.

Limp hands /Hanging hands	boredom
Flat hands	silent questions
Open hands	trust, interest
Clenched hands	tension and
frustration	
Covered hands	insecurity
Clinging hands	uncertainty
Wringing hands	discomfort/tension
Fists	determination, anger
Crossing the arms	negative attitude
Arms and legs uncrossed	attentive
Double handed handshake	intimacy
Dead fish handshake	formality
Glove handshake	politician's handshake

Postures

- ❑ A public speaker should consider himself as the most impactful visual element they could present.
- ❑ Prof. Amy Cuddy through her research classified a set of bodily postures as “power poses.”
- ❑ **“Fake it till [you] make it” (Cuddy 1367)**
- ❑ Her study suggests that practising a powerful pose before a final presentation boosts one’s confidence.
- ❑ Assuming power poses leads to peak performance by increasing one’s testosterone levels (dominance hormone) and decreasing cortisol (stress hormone).



"High Power" body language (top row)
vs.
"Low Power" body language (bottom row)

(Images courtesy of Amy Cuddy, Harvard University)



Gait

- ❑ Walk with purpose – Walk with confidence.
- ❑ Direct your whole body – shoulders, hips and toe towards the audience.
- ❑ Move a step forward when delivering the important message.
- ❑ Walk with firm steps.
- ❑ Stay connected with the whole group of listeners.
- ❑ Although, passive talk without movement can sound dull; too much movement can cause distraction too.
- ❑ A balance of movement is essential.



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Arm Movements

- A confident speaker keeps their arms wide open facing the audience.
- It expresses confidence and it reduces the distance between speaker and listener.
- Famous speaker Dananjaya Hettiarachchi recommends keeping an open palm toward the audience as it reveals openness in communication and intent towards connection.
- He also warns not to lean on the podium and advises to keep a comfortable distance.

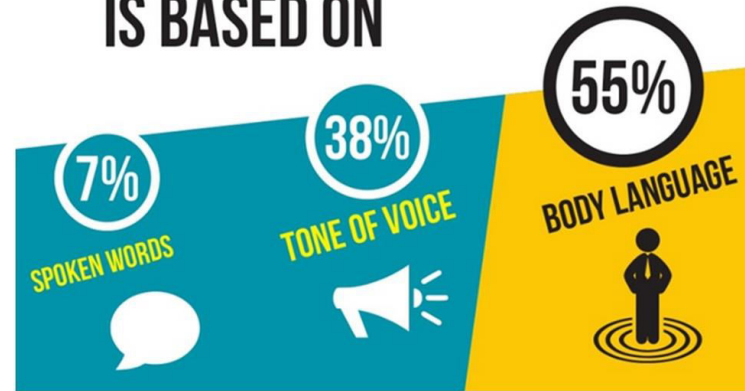


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Importance of Kinesics in Public Speaking

- ✓ Awareness of kinesics is essential for a public speaker.
- ✓ It helps to improve the quality of speech on a multi-dimensional level.
- ✓ Proper body-word co-ordination doubles the effect of the message delivered.
- ✓ Moreover, it grooms one's own overall personality and boosts self-confidence.

A FIRST IMPRESSION IS BASED ON



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Some Tips about Body Action

- ❖ Adapt your body action to the empathy of the audience.
- ❖ Maintain proper eye contact with the audience and use body action meaningfully.
- ❖ Avoid cracking knuckles, scratching head/eyebrows and twitching nose.
- ❖ Walk but avoid constant pacing and pussyfooting.
- ❖ Concentrate on words but do not forget your body.

There's language in her eye, her cheek, her lip,
Nay, her foot speaks; her wanton spirits lookout
At every joint and motive of her body.“

- *Troilus and Cressida* (Act IV, Scene V)

Thank You

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Public Speaking

Lecture 23: Proxemics

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DEPARTMENT OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES



“Language has time
as its element, all
other media have
space as their
element.”

- Soren Kierkegaard



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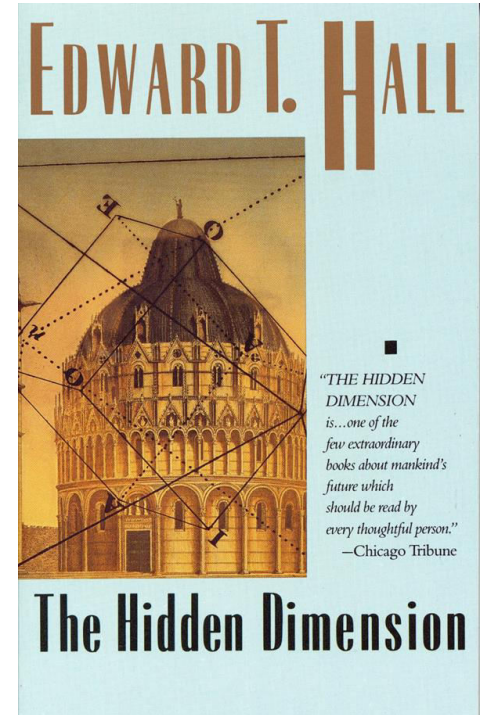
Introduction

- ❖ A term coined by cultural anthropologist Edward T. Hall in his book *The Hidden Dimension*, written in 1963.
- ❖ It is about how people understand and use space in a cultural context.
- ❖ While talking about human perceptions of social space and personal space, Hall defines **proxemics** as “the interrelated observations and theories of man's use of space as a specialized elaboration of culture” (Hall 1)



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Proximity + Phonemics = Proxemics



Proxemics: Space, Culture & Communication

- Spatial Communication
 - Close study/ Awareness of physical space
 - Behavioral norms
 - Cultural variations
- Proxemics, as a field of non-verbal communication, tries to ground the relationship “between man and the cultural dimension is one in which both *man and his environment participate in moulding each other*” (Hall 4)



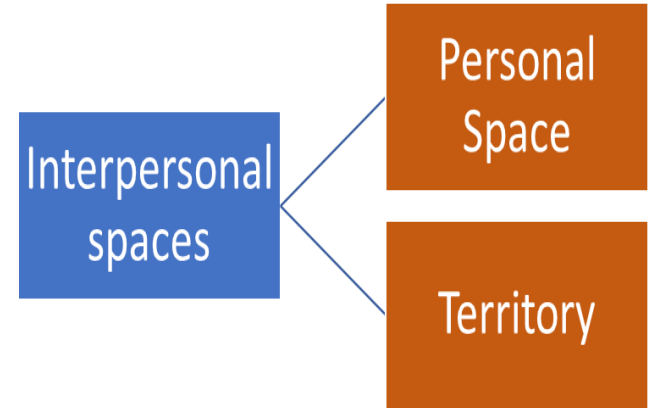
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Communication across Spaces

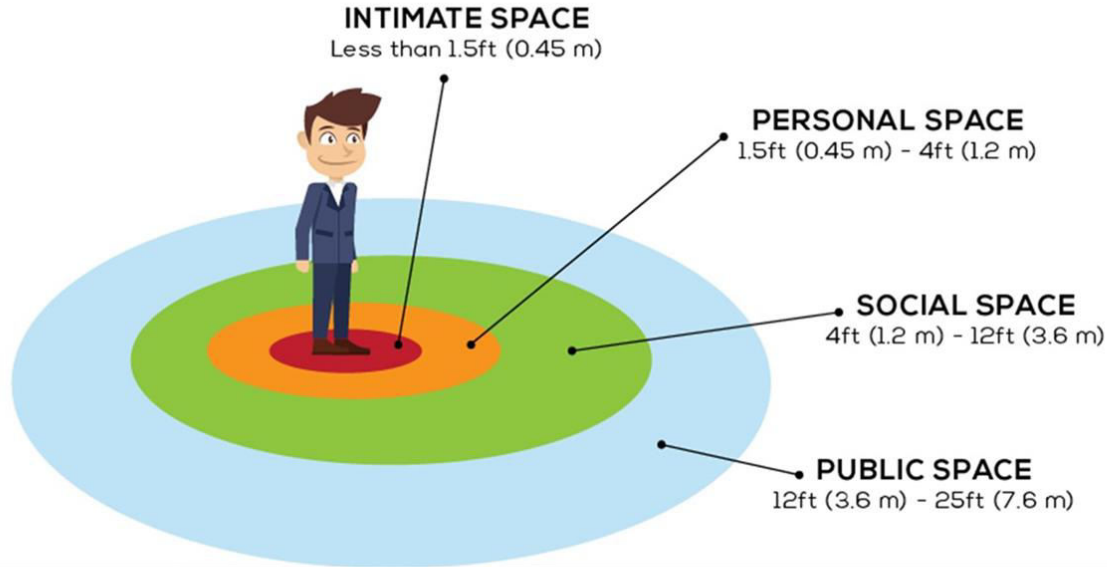
1. Edward Hall divided human perception of spatiality into two broad categories namely:
 - a. Personal Space
 - b. Territory
2. Personal space is understood as the distance at which the individual could be touched physically.

“the man’s boundary begins and ends with his skin.” (Hall 115)

- ☐ Meanwhile, the concept of “territory” is associated with animals and birds.
- ☐ Territory suggests the critical distance around which “flight-or-fight reaction” takes place.



Space Zones



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*all the four spaces are further categorized into close/ far phases.

Intimate distance

- Close phase:
 - Overload of sensory inputs.
 - Overwhelming reaction from the receiver.
 - Output type: Highly positive or negative
- Far phase: (6-18 inches)
 - Phase of cultural differences, esp. while greeting gestures.
 - High risk of offending/ getting offended.



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Personal distance

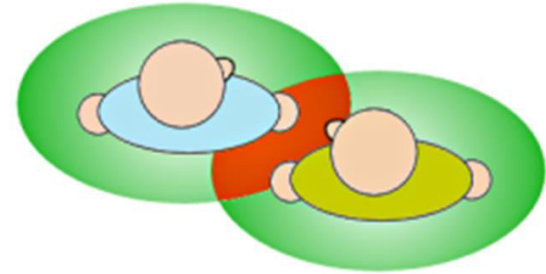
A small protective sphere or body bubble.

Close Phase: (1 ½ - 2 ½ feet)

- Expresses the intimacy of the relationship.
- Example: Husband & Wife sharing their personal spheres.

Far Phase: (2 ½ - 4 feet)

- Keeping someone at an “arm’s length” (120)
- Last point for establishing physical contact/ touch.
- Regulated and normal sensory inputs.



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Social Zones

Touch is reduced or entirely removed at this zone.

Voice plays a primary role in communication.

Close phase: (4 – 7 feet)

- Impersonal business zone.
- Work relationships.
- Social gathering

Far Phase: (7 – 12 feet)

- Formal business zone.
- Interviews, Meetings, Conferences etc.



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Public Zones

Sensorial shifts occur with respect to loss of familiarity.

Close phase: (12 – 25 feet)

- “Careful choice of words and phrasing...occurs” (Hall 123)
- Formal style

Far phase: (25 feet or more)

- A distance set around public speakers.
- Voice loses its subtlety.
- Exaggeration of non-verbal communication is required.
- High usage of kinesics.



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Interpersonal Distances

Communication is carried out in two different forms of distances:

1. Horizontal Distances (Space Zones)
2. Vertical Distances (Power Zones)



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The Cultural Dilemma



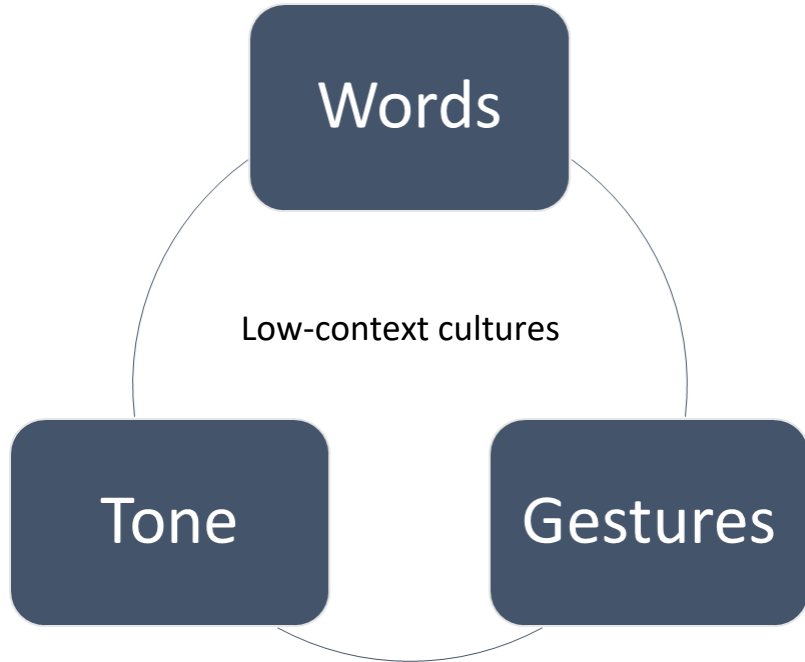
People in an elevator in North America.



The same people if they grew up in Italy.

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Intercultural Differences



Contd...

- Mehrabian says: “Status manifests itself by relaxed posture and way of interacting.”
- Most non verbal communication at work in U.S. reinforces power.
- You and I are close friends.



Perceptions of Space

1. Visual space
2. Auditory space
3. Olfactory Space
4. Thermal Space
5. Tactile space

Proper spatial awareness through a different sensorial medium is essential for a speaker to recognize the situational context and changes.

Enhanced perception of spaces leads to increased output in communication.

Space in Public Speaking

- ❖ We are conscious of others near us, especially if they are behind us.
- ❖ A Speaker is prepared to be unaware of physical surroundings.
- ❖ A speaker should become conscious of how close he should stand to the audience.
- ❖ It is easier to understand the speech of a person one can see.

Anglo-Saxons stand at a reserved distance when conversing, while the Spanish and Italian peoples stand much closer. At international conferences you can often see Americans and British people edging backwards, pursued by Italians and Spaniards trying to get to their usual degrees of closeness.

(Christopher Turk in *Effective Speaking*)



Some Tips

- ✓ Check the room and physical arrangement in advance.
- ✓ Request for change if required. Ensure proper ventilation.
- ✓ Be aware of audience's cultural background.
- ✓ Push the rostrum to one side and stand in front of the table.

Digital Proxemics

- ❑ Proxemics is a marker of intercultural communication.
- ❑ With increasing trends toward digital culture, one can observe changes in human perceptions of space too.

“As culture changes, so changes the rule of proxemics”
(McArthur 25)

- Smart cities
- Digital classrooms
- Sentient objects
- Wearable e-gadgets

The above additions to our communication space have redefined proxemics on multiple levels.



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“Proximity breeds familiarity, and familiarity breeds comfort.”

- Nicholas Sparks in *The Lucky One*

Thank You

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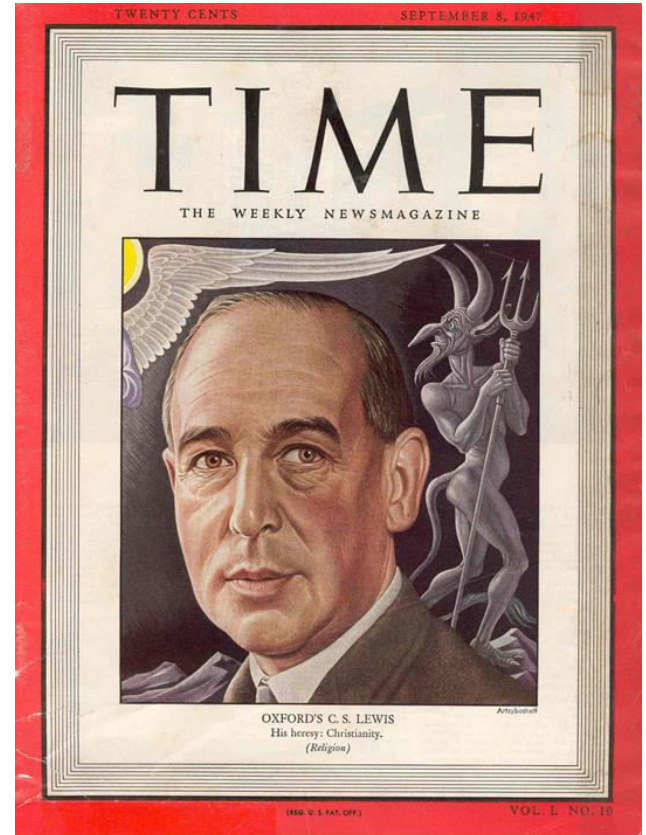
Lecture 24: Chronemics

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DEPARTMENT OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES



“For the Present is the point
at which time touches the
eternity”
- C.S. Lewis



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Introduction

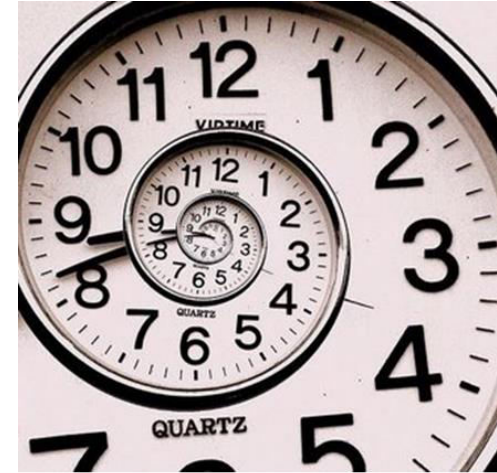
- ❖ Study of time in relation to human communication.
- ❖ The term was coined by Thomas Bruneau in the year 1979.

“It is not space that is the hidden dimension of human communication, but it is time that is hidden and is a major aspect of all areas of semiotic or nonverbal communication.”

(Bruneau 91)

Time,
Timing
Tempo

} 3 Essentials of Chronemics



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Time Talks

- ❖ The time at which communication occurs suggests the nature and importance of communication. Example: An early morning telephone call or a late-night call might signify urgency.
- ❖ In Western culture, advance notice is rendered for the scheduling of events.
- ❖ Edward Hall termed this particular preparatory duration before the main event as “lead time”.
- ❖ Western culture perceives time as “a road to the future” while for many other native cultures “time is all that is present”.

Types of Time

Social time

Psychological
time

Cultural
Time

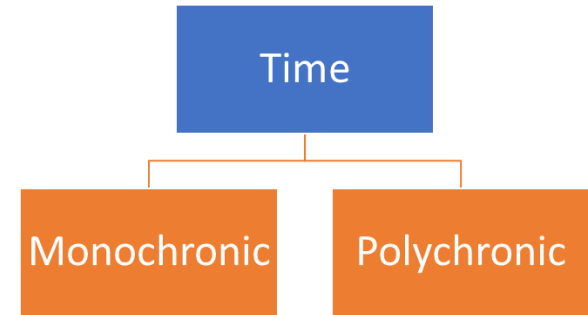
Biological
time

Contd...

- Social time: It refers to how a particular society as a group perceives, understands and equips time.
- Psychological time: It refers to an individual's own temporal experiences in relation to the duration, pace and succession of an event.
- Biological time: It includes our bodily understanding of time to carry out our diurnals at regular intervals.
- Cultural time: A cultural outlook towards time orientation in terms of the culture's preference towards its past, present and future.

Time Perceptions

- ❖ •Time as a concept is perceived differently in various parts of the world.
- ❖ •It varies on the basis of culture, nation, ethnicity and traditional customs.
- ❖ •In general, time is categorized into largely two categories:
 - i. Monochronic
 - ii. Polychronic



Monochronic Time

- Individualistic. Low-context cultures.
- “One thing at a time” is the mantra.
- Schedules are kept tight and respected.
- Punctuality is upheld.
- Precision is appreciated.
- M-time is observed in German, North American and North European cultures.



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Polychronic Time

- ❖ Group-based. High-context culture.
- ❖ Multi-tasking is a talent.
- ❖ High interpersonal values.
- ❖ Time is flexible.
- ❖ Schedules are loose or non-existent.
- ❖ P-time patterned people are more past and present-oriented than expressing eagerness towards the future.
- ❖ P-time is observed in Asian, African and Latin cultures.



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Time Orientations

- ❑ Humans develop time cognitivism over the age, depending upon their culture and upbringing.
- ❑ There are four different types of time orientation:
 1. Past
 2. Present
 3. Future
 4. Timeline



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Four Types of Time Orientations

Past

- Experience based communication.

Present

- Dedicated and Mindful usage of time.

Future

- Goal-oriented communication.

Time-line

- Detail oriented.

Time and Negotiation

- Time speaks a lot, especially when it is communication between parties of different power hierarchies.

1. Waiting time

2. Talk time

3. Work Time

The parties with higher power positions shall afford to bend time as per their convenience.

The subordinate group are bound to stick to their time constraints.



Timing and Time-keeping

“The clock may be the machine of all the machines” (Bruneau 428)

- Mumford notes that the primary characteristic of human civilization is its **temporal regularity**.
- Time keeping allows one to keep track of things that happened and happening.
- In public speaking, it becomes an integral part to stick to the time regulations.
- In formal scenarios, it is observed that timekeeping:
 - Optimizes individual performances.
 - Increases clarity in communication.
 - Provides more accuracy without any delays or errors.

Speech Chronemics

- ☐ The term “speech chronemics” is introduced by psychologist H.P. Krüger.
- ☐ It elucidates upon time as a hidden dimension of speech.
- ☐ His research work focused on analyzing speech signal patterns.
- ☐ The patterns consisted of two primary distinctions:
 - ☐ Speaking (Ons)
 - ☐ Pausing (Offs)
- ☐ The time taken by participants while speaking and pausing was studied in order to understand the larger effect of communication. (Krüger 11)

Importance of Timing in Public Speaking

- A public speaker should make the most out of given time stipulations to gain successful feedback.
- Time awareness – Timers are available in certain scenarios. However, wearing a watch comes in handy.
- Repetitive rehearsal in accordance with the given time limit.
- Time utilization is not just for speakers but also for listeners.
- A speaker should allow time for listeners to react and engage with the content delivered.

Avoid Chronarchy

- ❑ Wright pinpoints “the tyranny of clockworks” in the contemporary world.
- ❑ Communication theorists like Bruneau suggest that humans should use time and not let it be another way around.
- ❑ “Let chronarchy, then, be not merely ‘rule by time’, but ‘regimentation of man by time-keeping’ ” (Bruneau 428)
- ❑ Objective timekeeping should be controlled. Intercultural differences in perception of time must be embraced and accommodated.

Time matters

- ❖ Adrenalin
- ❖ Subject concern
- ❖ Contractual



Contd...

- ❖ The speaker and the audience are in quite the opposite state.
- ❖ Speakers are emotionally involved in what they are saying.
- ❖ Timing of a speaker's talk is a contract with the audience.
- ❖ Span of memory and attention is limited.
- ❖ Good timing lends security to the audience and helps the speaker reflect his competence.



"The entire universe is weighted toward rhythm . . . everywhere, as in a cosmic dance, natural bodies are doing their rounds . . . the universe is littered with clocks."

- Dora Marsden

Thank You

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IIT ROORKEE



NPTEL ONLINE
CERTIFICATION COURSE

Public Speaking

Lecture 25: Haptics

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“[Touch is] the foundation for communication with the world around us, and probably the single sense that is as old as life itself” (Sachs 28)

Haptic, from the Greek word Haptesthai, means ‘Of, pertaining to, or relating to the sense of touch or tactile sensations’ (OED 1989, 2nd edn).



Introduction

- ❖ The term was coined in the year 1892 by Max Dessoir.
- ❖ The term has its origin in the Greek word *haptain* (meaning: to fasten).
- ❖ Human skin happens to be the largest sensory organ.
- ❖ It is responsible for receiving tactile responses and even communication.
- ❖ It provides the basis for the other sensory stimuli such as sight and hearing.
- ❖ The knowledge of human touch is essential for establishing a human-to-human connection through communication.

Connecting People



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Level of Haptics



And I found that of all the senses the eye was the most superficial, the ear the most haughty, smell the most voluptuous, taste the most superstitious and inconstant, touch the most profound and philosophical.

-Diderot, 'Letter on the Blind,'
1749

Touch in Professional Life

- ❖ In a professional scenario, the aspect of touch has to be dealt with both confidence and caution.
- ❖ A gesture of encouragement can lead to tremendous motivation for one individual but might trigger proxemic boundary violation for another.
- ❖ Unlike words and actions, with touch one directly contacts the other person.
- ❖ The contact zone may likely offer a better space for mutual confidence and trust.
- ❖ It depends upon the person sending a signal to appropriately convey his values through means of touch.
- ❖ Handshakes play a key role in the professional side of haptics.



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Types of Handshakes

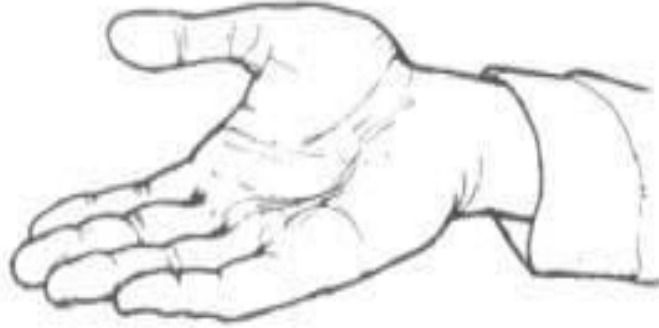
Body language experts Allan & Barbara Pease in their book *The Definitive Book of Body Language* illustrate different types of handshakes and their function:

- ❑ The Stiff-Arm Thrust: Stretched out hands. Distanced Handshake.
- ❑ The Socket-Wrencher: Strong grip. Closer Handshake.
- ❑ The Pump Handle: Over-enthusiastic. Rigorous shaking.
- ❑ The Bone-Crusher: Overstepping and Dominant.
- ❑ The Wet Fish: Sweaty hands. Nervous. Lacks Confidence.

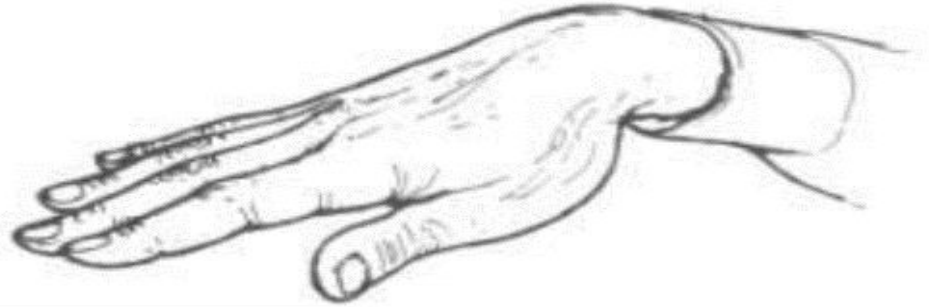


Contd...

Submissive palm position



Dominant palm position



Aggressive palm position

Touch in Social Life

- Touch is an integral part of establishing social well-being for an individual.
- Gentsch et al (2015) in their research suggested the importance of active interpersonal touch which ultimately led way to overall health benefits in adulthood and development.
- It is practised amongst different social circles such as family, friends, etc.
- The dimensions of social touch may vary depending upon the socio-cultural context in which communication occurs.



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Touch has a memory. O say, love, say,
What can I do to kill it and be free
In my old liberty? (John Keats)

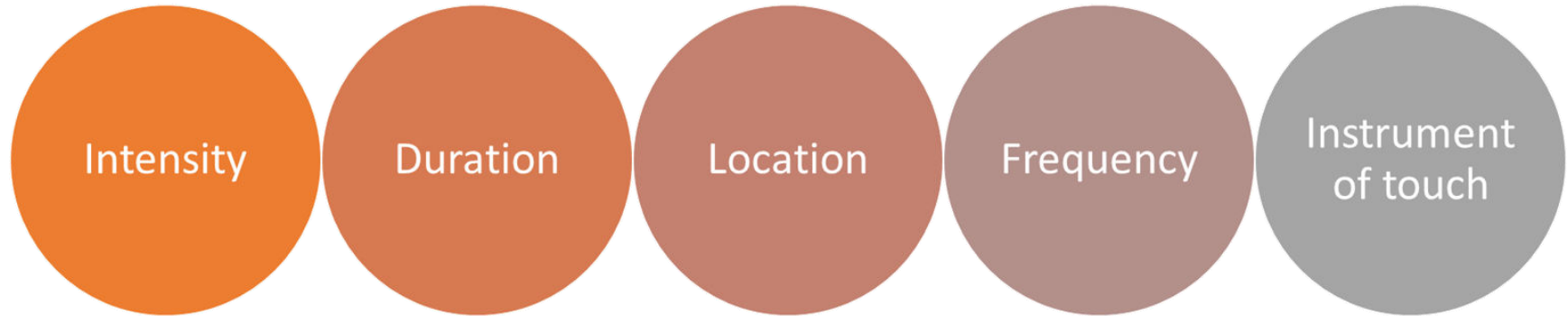
Touch in Personal Relationships

- ❖ “Contact comfort” is a primary need for higher-order mammals. (Burgoon 146)
- ❖ At the level of intimate relationships, the touch is usually equipped to express affection and provide comfort.
- ❖ Studies reveal the important role of interpersonal touch in conveying emotions such as love, gratitude and sympathy.
- ❖ Slight hesitation may also convey significant negative feelings such as fear, anxiety etc.



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Dimension of Haptics



Contd...

- ❑ **Intensity:** It refers to the pressure exerted by one person's touch on another person. **Hard/ Soft.** Example: A pat on the cheek can be taken as a slap if done harder.
- ❑ **Duration:** The time taken to establish a communicative contact. Example: A handshake might turn awkward if done for long as in the “pump handle” style.
- ❑ **Location:** Part of the body touched. Example: Touching the feet of elders is a sign of respect in Indian families.
- ❑ **Frequency:** Number of touches. Example: A pat on the shoulder might get attention whereas multiple pats might imply encouragement.
- ❑ **Instrument of touch:** Object or Organ through which a touch is established. Example: Stretching out the baton in the relay is more essential than directly touching the teammate.

Meanings of Touch

Jones and Yarbrough categorize seven main meanings generated out of haptic communication.



Positive affect



Playful



Control



Ritualistic



Hybrid



Task-related



Accidental

Differences in Touch

Many factors become important when establishing the nature of contact zone:

- ✓ Environment
- ✓ Age
- ✓ Gender
- ✓ Status
- ✓ Relationship

The culmination of the above factors helps in deciding if a given culture is high-contact culture or low-contact culture.

High contact & Low contact culture

High contact culture:

- Implicit communication: non-verbal.
- People form groups close to each other while engaging in a conversation.
- Establishment of direct eye contact.

Low contact culture:

- Stand farther and spread out.
- Less eye contact.
- Avoid unnecessary touch.
- Louder and more verbal.

Touch is culturally oriented.

- ✓ In Thailand and Laos, it is rude for strangers to touch a child on the top of head.
- ✓ People in U.S are touch deprived.
- ✓ In France people may touch each other hundred times in an hour.
- ✓ Left hand is not considered good to offer anything to another in some cultures.
- ✓ Jones and Yarbrough in their study showed 12 meanings communicated with touch— affection, appreciation, attention getting, compliance, announcing a response, departures, greetings, inclusion, playful affection, playful aggression, sexual interest, and support.



Dr. Desmond Morris' Description of Gestures

- ❖ Hand-to- face gestures
- ❖ The mouth-guard
- ❖ The eye-rub
- ❖ The ear rub
- ❖ The neck scratch
- ❖ The collar pull
- ❖ Fingers in the mouth



Haptic Technology

- ❑ With the advent of technology, it is now even possible to transfer tactile stimulation i.e. experience of touch through means of enhanced machines and robots.
- ❑ Apart from its widespread demand in the field of gaming, virtual reality (VR) systems are created at present with the extension of the haptic interface.



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Haptics and Disability

- Haptic technology plays a key role in supporting people with disability.
- The enhanced haptic modality helps in navigation for those who are visually impaired.
- Even people with hearing disability are assisted to engage in music and dance activities through means of haptic assistance.



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“Touch comes before sight, before speech
It is the first language, and the last, and it
always tells the truth.”

- Margaret Atwood

Thank You

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